Current Affairs — 19 October

Daily class (Navami, last day of Navratri) | Current affairs + BS-VII, GST Council, CICA, World Bank/IMF meetings

*English rendering of the Hindi class transcript. Garbled names/figures in the auto-generated transcript are marked **[unclear]** or **[as heard]**. Answer options were on screen (not in the transcript), so Part B gives question → correct answer.*

PART A — TOPIC-WISE NOTES WITH QUICK REVISION

1. Kolkata Durga Puja Pandal Stampede & UNESCO Heritage

- **Stampede** at the **Chor Bagan Durga Puja pandal, North Kolkata** (Saturday): about **19–20 deaths** and **25+ injured**; causes — **overcrowding** on a weekend, **sudden heavy rain** making people run for shelter; the **organisers were detained**. West Bengal CM **Suvendu** announced **₹25 lakh** per victim's family plus a **job**.
- **Durga Puja** was added to UNESCO's **Intangible Cultural Heritage** list in **2021**; India has **16** elements on the intangible list — **Diwali** is the latest (16th) [as stated]. On the tangible (World Heritage) list India has **45** sites; the latest is **Sarnath** (near Varanasi, UP) [as stated].
- **Navratri** = 9 days (today is the last day); **Dussehra tomorrow**. **Kolkata** (capital of West Bengal) lies on the **Hooghly River**; called the **'City of Joy'**. (Aside: firing at actor Tiger Shroff — he is safe.)

⚡ **QUICK REVISION**

› Chor Bagan pandal, North Kolkata — 19–20 dead, 25+ injured; CM Suvendu: ₹25 lakh + job

› Durga Puja → UNESCO intangible list 2021 | Intangible 16 (latest Diwali) | Tangible 45 (latest Sarnath)

2. Appointments & Diplomacy

- **India's next Ambassador to Nepal: Sudhakar Dalela** — **IFS (1993 batch)**; was India's **Sherpa** for the **18th BRICS summit hosted by India** (first time a 'Sherpa' post was created for BRICS; earlier only in G20); worked on **I2U2** (USA, UAE, India, Israel); earlier **Ambassador to Bhutan**; worked in the Ministry of External Affairs.
- **India's next Ambassador to Mexico: Jetham Gangte** [as heard].
- **FADA 38th President: Giridhar** (Sai Giridhar). **Manish Agarwal** — General Manager, **Integral Coach Factory (ICF)**.
- **Deputy Chief of Air Staff: Tejpal Singh** (a student's answer 'Amarpreet Singh' was wrong).
- **Varsha Ashok** [as heard] heads the **Geological Survey of India (GSI)**.
- **Ajinkya Rahane** announced retirement — from **cricket**.
- **Nirmal [Purja — as heard]** — Nepali **mountaineer**, died recently (cause heard as 'Elasia' **[unclear]**).
- **Vidya Saathi** — **Bihar**'s online platform giving **24-hour** help to students. **4th Indo-German Environment Forum** — **Delhi**. **Flex SBI Card** — Google Pay + SBI Card co-branded credit card. **Vessel 'Nipan'** [as heard] handed to the Navy — built by **Hindustan Shipyard Limited**.

⚡ **QUICK REVISION**

› Amb. to Nepal → Sudhakar Dalela (IFS 1993; BRICS Sherpa; ex-Amb. to Bhutan) | Amb. to Mexico → Jetham Gangte

› FADA → Giridhar | ICF GM → Manish Agarwal | Dy Chief of Air Staff → Tejpal Singh | GSI → Varsha Ashok

› Flex SBI Card = Google Pay + SBI Card | Vidya Saathi → Bihar | Indo-German Env. Forum → Delhi

3. Nepal Recap

- **Nepal** — landlocked; **Budhi Gandaki** floods/landslide; capital **Kathmandu**; **SAARC HQ**; India–Nepal exercise **Surya Kiran**; border dispute with **Uttarakhand** over **Limpiyadhura**.
- Rivers: **Koshi** (from the Nepal–Tibet region), **Arun**, **Narayani** (= Gandak), **Kali**.
- **PM: Balen (Balan) Shah** [as heard]; **President: Ram Chandra Paudel** [as heard 'Padel'].

⚡ **QUICK REVISION**

› Nepal: Kathmandu, SAARC HQ, Surya Kiran, Limpiyadhura (Uttarakhand), Koshi/Arun/Narayani/Kali

› PM Balen Shah | President Ram Chandra Paudel

4. World Bank / IMF / SCO / BRICS 2027 & Related

- **2026 Boards of Governors meeting** (World Bank + IMF): **Bangkok, Thailand**. **2027 meeting → Pakistan** (will host; earlier hosted in **1953**; teacher doubts it; chance after ~70 years). **SCO 2027 summit → Pakistan** too. **BRICS 2027 → China**. **SCO 2026** was in **Kyrgyzstan**.
- **World Bank:** HQ **Washington DC**; formed **1944/1945** (began work **1945**); head **Ajay Banga**; members **189** (heard also 191). **IMF** (the 'mausi' of World Bank): head **Kristalina Georgieva**. Each has a **Board of Governors**.
- **Indus Waters Treaty: 1960**, India–Pakistan, brokered by the **World Bank**. **Karachi** — Pakistan's important port on the **Arabian Sea**; the **Indus** forms its delta there.
- **CICA** (Conference on Interaction and Confidence Building Measures in Asia): idea proposed in **1992** by **Nursultan Nazarbayev** (Kazakhstan); first meeting **Almaty (Kazakhstan)**; aims at peace, security, cooperation and fighting terrorism in Asia; **28 member countries**; **India is a founding member**; **Laos** the latest member; **7th summit at Baku** (capital of **Azerbaijan**, on the **Caspian Sea**); India represented by **Kirti Vardhan** [as heard].
- **Alluri Sitarama Raju International Airport** (**Andhra Pradesh**) inaugurated by PM Modi.

⚡ **QUICK REVISION**

› WB+IMF Governors 2026 → Bangkok; 2027 → Pakistan (1953 earlier) | SCO 2027 → Pakistan | BRICS 2027 → China | SCO 2026 → Kyrgyzstan

› World Bank: Washington, 1944/45, Ajay Banga | IMF: Georgieva | Indus Waters Treaty 1960 (World Bank)

› CICA: proposed 1992 (Nazarbayev), first Almaty, 28 members, India founding, Laos latest, 7th Baku (Azerbaijan)

5. Days & Health

- **World Wide Web Day — 1 Aug** [as stated]; **National Mountain Climbing Day — 1 Aug**; **World Breastfeeding Week — 1–7 Aug**; **7 Aug** = National **Handloom Day** and **Javelin Throw Day**.
- **World Health Summit 2026** — **Berlin, Germany** (Europe); organised under **WHO** (formed **7 April 1948** — as stated '1 April'; HQ **Geneva**; head **Dr. Tedros**); held **11–13 Oct 2026**; theme **'From Crisis to Resilience'**; first held **2009**; **4,000+** participants; funding announced for countries with health crises (e.g., **Bangladesh** women's health; **Pakistan and Afghanistan** conflict areas); use of AI ('SI') for online treatment.
- **Deakin University** (Australia) campus opened in **Gujarat**.

⚡ **QUICK REVISION**

› WWW Day & Mountain Climbing Day 1 Aug | Breastfeeding Week 1–7 Aug | 7 Aug Handloom + Javelin Day

› World Health Summit → Berlin, 11–13 Oct, 'From Crisis to Resilience', first 2009 | WHO Geneva, 1948, Tedros

6. BS-VII Emission Norms & Fuel

- **BS** = **Bharat Stage** emission standards (launched from **Delhi**); India targets **carbon neutrality by 2070**; vehicles are moving to EVs and fuel saving. Currently **BS-VI**; **BS-VII phase 1 from April 2029**, **phase 2 from 1 April 2031**, a **third phase** later [month as heard].
- **Mashelkar Committee** — formed **2002**; recommended in **2003**; produced the **National Auto Fuel Policy (2003)**; BS first arrived in **2000**.
- **Ethanol blending** is done using **sugarcane**.
- **Sarvam AI** — Indian AI company that built **sovereign AI solutions** for India (IBM partner).

⚡ **QUICK REVISION**

› BS = Bharat Stage | BS-VI now; BS-VII phase 1 Apr 2029, phase 2 1 Apr 2031 | Mashelkar Committee 2002/2003, National Auto Fuel Policy

› Ethanol ← sugarcane | Sarvam AI → sovereign AI

7. GST Council & Standing Committee

- **GST Council** is a **constitutional body**, chaired by the **Finance Minister** (**Nirmala Sitharaman**). It is forming a **Standing Committee** with **12 states**: **5 permanent** — **Karnataka, Maharashtra, Uttar Pradesh, Gujarat, Tamil Nadu**; **7 rotating** — each stays **2 years** (like UN permanent members).
- **GST** = Goods and Services Tax, an **indirect tax**: **CGST, SGST, IGST**; slabs **0%, 5%, 18%, 40%** (luxury goods and tobacco in 40%). GST bill **2016**; Constitution amended — effective **1 July 2017**; **Kelkar Committee** recommendation [as stated]; 'Father of GST' named in class as **Atal Bihari Vajpayee** [as stated].
- **Textile Ministry** is organising the (garbled) 'GI & Beyond'-type summit [**unclear**].

⚡ **QUICK REVISION**

› GST Council → constitutional, chaired by FM Sitharaman | Standing Committee: 12 states = 5 permanent (KA, MH, UP, GJ, TN) + 7 rotating (2 yrs)

› GST: CGST, SGST, IGST | slabs 0/5/18/40 | effective 1 Jul 2017 | Textile Ministry hosts the summit

8. Defence — Jwala Micro-Missile

- **Jwala micro-missile** built by **IG Defence** — a **private company**; the **first** missile made by a private company in India (trial stage). **Surface-to-air**, short range **2–5 km**, altitude **50 m to 5,000 m**; uses **solid rocket motor**; **hard-kill interceptor** against **drones** and micro-missiles; has an **AI-based grid defence system** and a detection beam [as heard 'T-shool beam'].

⚡ **QUICK REVISION**

› Jwala micro-missile → IG Defence (private), surface-to-air, 2–5 km, 50–5,000 m, solid rocket motor, anti-drone

9. Persons & Para Games

- **Cheruvayal K. Raman** [as heard] — '**Father of Paddy**', from **Kerala (Wayanad)**; died aged **74** [death place as stated: Warangal]; conserved about **45 endangered indigenous rice varieties**; worked for a **gene bank**; **Padma Shri 2023**; spoke at the biodiversity conference in **Hyderabad (2011)** and the world agriculture conference in **Brazil**.
- **Asian Para Games 2026** — **Nagoya, Japan**; opened **18 Oct**, ends **24 Oct**; first held **2010**; every **4 years**; last edition in **China**. India's flag-bearers: planned **Bhavina Patel** (para table tennis) with **Pramod Bhagat** (para badminton) — but Bhavina was replaced by **Simran Sharma** (sprinter) to rest before her quarter-final. Asian Games opening flag-bearers (Nagoya): **Manu Bhaker** and **Pawan** (kabaddi). Bhavina won **silver at Tokyo Paralympics** (first Indian para TT medal).

⚡ **QUICK REVISION**

› C.K. Raman → 'Father of Paddy', Kerala, Padma Shri 2023, 74 yrs

› Asian Para Games 2026 → Nagoya, 18–24 Oct, first 2010 | Flag-bearer: Simran Sharma (replaced Bhavina Patel) + Pramod Bhagat

10. Announcements

- **11 AM class not held today**; from tomorrow the 11 AM slot covers important **CHSL** topics. **New: 4 PM live GD (SSC GD) series** from today — first test paper solved live (not recorded); open to MTS, CHSL and Foundation 2027 students. **Offer:** code **Kriti10** — **3 months + 3 months free**. More content to be added from **21 Oct**. Class PDF on Telegram.

⚡ **QUICK REVISION**

› 4 PM live GD test series from today | 11 AM: CHSL topics from tomorrow | Code Kriti10: 3 + 3 months

PART B — ALL MCQs FROM THE CLASS (Question → Correct Answer)

Question as asked in class → correct answer given by the teacher.

#	Question	Answer
1	Where did the stampede occur in West Bengal (Saturday)?	**Chor Bagan Durga Puja pandal, North Kolkata**
2	Deaths / injured in the stampede?	**About 19–20 dead; 25+ injured**

#	Question	Answer
3	Compensation announced by CM Suvendu?	₹25 lakh + a job per family
4	Durga Puja added to UNESCO intangible list in?	2021
5	Latest addition to UNESCO intangible list (16th)? Tangible latest?	Diwali; Sarnath
6	Total Indian sites on UNESCO tangible list?	45 [as stated]
7	Vidya Saathi launched in which state?	Bihar (24-hour online help)
8	4th Indo-German Environment Forum venue?	Delhi
9	38th President of FADA?	Giridhar (Sai Giridhar)
10	India's next Ambassador to Nepal?	Sudhakar Dalela
11	Dalela was Sherpa for which summit?	18th BRICS summit (India)
12	Dalela's earlier posting?	Ambassador to Bhutan; IFS 1993
13	India's next Ambassador to Mexico?	Jetham Gangte [as heard]
14	Flex SBI Card is co-branded with?	Google Pay
15	Shipyard that built 'Nipan' for the Navy?	Hindustan Shipyard Limited
16	Host of World Bank–IMF Boards of Governors 2027?	Pakistan
17	2026 World Bank–IMF meeting venue?	Bangkok, Thailand
18	SCO 2027 summit host? SCO 2026?	Pakistan; Kyrgyzstan
19	BRICS 2027 host?	China
20	Indus Waters Treaty — year and mediator?	1960; World Bank
21	Ajinkya Rahane retired from which sport?	Cricket
22	General Manager of Integral Coach Factory?	Manish Agarwal
23	Alluri Sitarama Raju International Airport — state?	Andhra Pradesh
24	CICA proposed in 1992 by?	Nursultan Nazarbayev (Kazakhstan)
25	CICA — first meeting; 7th summit; members?	Almaty; Baku (Azerbaijan); 28
26	Latest CICA member? India's status?	Laos; founding member
27	World Wide Web Day / National Mountain Climbing Day?	1 August / 1 August
28	World Breastfeeding Week dates?	1–7 August
29	Which day is 7 August (India)?	National Handloom Day and Javelin Throw Day
30	World Health Summit 2026 venue, theme, years?	Berlin; From Crisis to Resilience; first 2009
31	Deputy Chief of Air Staff?	Tejpal Singh
32	Varsha Ashok leads which organisation?	Geological Survey of India
33	Ministry organising the (garbled) summit?	Ministry of Textiles
34	Permanent states in GST Council's Standing Committee?	Karnataka, Maharashtra, UP, Gujarat, Tamil Nadu
35	GST Council body type / chair?	Constitutional body; Finance Minister
36	GST slabs?	0%, 5%, 18%, 40%
37	Indigenous micro-missile 'Jwala' built by?	IG Defence (private company)
38	Jwala's range and altitude?	2–5 km; 50 m–5,000 m
39	BS full form? Recommended by?	Bharat Stage; Mashelkar Committee
40	BS-VII phase 1 / phase 2 start?	April 2029 / 1 April 2031
41	Indian AI company making sovereign AI (IBM partner)?	Sarvam AI
42	'Father of Paddy' (died aged 74)?	C.K. Raman (Kerala); Padma Shri 2023
43	Asian Para Games 2026 venue and end date?	Nagoya, Japan; 24 Oct
44	Who replaced Bhavina Patel as flag-bearer?	Simran Sharma
45	Asian Games flag-bearers (Nagoya)?	Manu Bhaker and Pawan (kabaddi)
46	First Para-TT medal for India at Tokyo Paralympics?	Silver (Bhavina Patel)
47	India–Nepal joint exercise?	Surya Kiran